

Companies are no longer counting on the payments from licenses or subscriptions alone to win over users but also offering a web-based solution for free. These services not only secure a backup of work files but also foster collaboration and real-time action. In this chapter, we'll filter down the top user-centric office suite packages currently available and present an assessment of what works for whom and how.

Google Drive

Google, by far, is the one company that has radically created a paradigm shift in the way in which users relate to its services. From giving us a cutting edge search engine to global map services, it was only a matter of time before Google plugged into the productivity office suite division with its unique innovations. And by far, its greatest contribution in this space has been Google Docs, which was an acquired property in 2006 from a software company called Upstartle.

Originally launched in 2005 as two separate applications – Writerly and Google Spreadsheets – Docs was integrated within Google's ecosystem by early 2007 and has gone on



to dominate the free cloud based office suite market since coming out of BETA in 2009. The services in the suite were slowly broadened and now include all the essential applications under the Google Drive app. The service has constantly been upgraded with an initial offering of only 1GB of storage, but is now capped at 15GB.

The Google Drive office suite contains all the necessary tools – Documents (word processor), Spreadsheets, Presentations, Form (customised forms) and Drawing (illustration and graphics). Google Drive supports various forms of file formats including Autodesk AutoCAD files, Adobe design formats, archive files like ZIP and RAR as well as Apple Pages files. Google has used its online expertise to make Google Drive compatible with all recently browsed programs for perfect formatting and layout across all major operating systems.

All the files used across the service are editable and sharable by numerous people in real time with collaborative tools such as instant messaging in